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Newworks - SceneFest: Elsewhere! Feb 25th



MISSED CONNECTIONS

A Craigslislt Play

Written by Zachary Everett-Lane and Levi Chaplin-Loebell

Feb.10th - 7pm & 11pm
Feb.11th - 2pm & 7pm

University Center
Studio Theatre

CreativeStaff credits

Co-Director/ Playwright
Zachary Everett-Lane
Dramaturg/ Playwright
Levi Chaplin-Loebell

Co-Director
Cole Schubert
Mentor Director
Katie Mae Ryan
Assistant Dramaturg
Esha Gupta



Submit your own
missed connection

To the people watching my show February 10-11th in the Studio Theater | m4?

You: Audience member, flipping through the program note, squinting in the dim lights of the studio theater. You are possibly intrigued, or maybe just a little bored while you wait for the show to start.

Me: Dramaturg and co-playwright, tasked with preparing you for the show without telling you what to think or spoiling what's to come.

What can I say, audience member? First of all, thank you. Zach and I poured more than a year of our lives into this script, and we couldn't be more excited to show you the result. It started on January 1st of 2022, as I sat on the floor of my friend's living room, next to the Christmas tree and wrapped in blankets. I received a text from Zach with a link to a post from the "Best of Craigslist" archive, entitled "Moving On is Hard To Do Sale (June 15)". We agreed that it would make a good monologue, and the idea quickly blossomed from there. Over the next several months, the project evolved into an hour-long tribute to the anonymous memoirists, solicitors, and poets of Craigslist. You can read more about our process on the About page of Missed Connections: A Craigslist Play's audience submissions website.

I like to conceptualize Missed Connections posts as an indulgence in a fantasy. I find it unlikely that the majority of Craigslist posters really believe they're going to reconnect with their intended recipients. It is impossible to know whether any of these people found what they were looking for, but the chances seem slim. In this play, a lot of questions are left unanswered, and the glimpses of life captured on stage are ephemeral. Ultimately, Missed Connections posts are a form of escapism. The website functions as a kind of diary, a place to shout into the void and escape one's troubles. A Missed Connection is a chance to believe in the power of mysteries and hope. Some characters in the play seek meaning in a mindless consumerist society, while others seek love in a disconnected environment, or even a second chance at life. Our story is in Seeking, and never in Finding.

Audience member, I hope you won't be disappointed that we left these stories unfinished and these questions unanswered. Instead, I urge you to look for answers yourself. Maybe under a small tree.

Yours in Craigslist,

Levi Chaplin-Loebell & Esha Gupta

do NOT contact me with unsolicited services or offers.

Cast

Anjali Thonakudi	Poe/Urñ Girl/Spatula Girl
Alex Newkirk	True Believer/Fish Girlfriend
Jesus Pelicano	Craigslist Addict/Gobsnacked Guest
	Sadistic Poster/Thurber Milford Finklestein
	A Great Guy/Regretful Monkey Donor
Lillian McDermott	Ugly Guy/Spatula Boyfriend/Commuter
Quincy Mangi	Music Thrifter/Muggee/Ex-Teenage Dirtbag
	Jaded Hag/Incredulous Poster/Noodle Fetishist
	Stupid White Ho/Mugger/Horny Undergraduate
Rohan Butani	Furry/Violent Poster
	Old Man/Trader Joe's Shopper
Tianyi He	Sex Positive Poster/JO BRO
	Fish Man/Injured Bicycleist/Man-Child
Arrim Jung	Blended Poster/Platform Observer
	Single Mother/Berett Launderer/Appalled Poster

Production Staff

Stephen Tao	Production Manager
Cynthia Xu	Mentor Production Manager
Nina Kanamalluru	Stage Manager
Cordelia Pride	Asst. Stage Manager
Abby Miller-Peterson	Co-Technical Director
Tiona Rubiano	Co-Technical Director

Implementers

Trey DuBoise	Co-Sound Engineer
Lance Miller	Co-Sound Engineer
Kira Lentz	Co-Master Electrician
Clarice Liu	Co-Master Electrician
Maddie Burroughs	Co-Scenic Head
Alex Echols	Co-Scenic Head
Kyr Brenneeman	H&M Head
Victoria Sosky	Costumes Head
Lucia Shen	House Manager

Designers

Inara Kardar	Scenic Designer
Plannery McNair	Co-Lighting Designer
Zoe Brown	Co-Lighting Designer
Fletcher Sun	Asst. Lighting Designer
Chloe Clover Brown	Sound Designer
Soomin Kong	Costume Designer
Ellie Burckhardt	H&M Designer
Chori Jun	Publicity Designer
Julia Liu	Asst. Publicity Designer

Special Thanks

Denis Lucy
Bianca Navas
Avi Wong
Ivan Onestak
TJ Young
Luke Jennings

Crew

H & M	Riley Zhao, Shravya Nandiyala
Scenic	Chloe Clover Brown
Costume	Victoria Sosky
Lighting	Brian Truong, Treadora Gildengers, Tiona Rubiano, Abby Miller-Peterson
Boardop	Fletcher Sun

